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**r/GooglePixel** • 3mo ago

Vast_Umpire_3713

...

OTA : are updates sent by Google or by my carrier ?

Hi,

I have an unlocked pixel phone. I receive Google updates on a timely manner (the same day as most of people here). I always believed that I receive those updates directly from Google but based on what I've read on other posts my carrier could have some control over it. If yes then how ? Knowing that I always update through wifi. How can carrier intervene ? Does Google send the updates to the carriers the the latter sends it to the user ?

Edit: After digging deeper in the topic I've found the following post that says that this particularly occurs in the USA (and some other countries).

<https://www.reddit.com/r/Android/s/pzcZhlwBmz>



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**matteventu** • 3mo ago • Edited 3mo ago

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Google develops the update -> in some countries, Google sends the update to carriers for certification (this isn't actually that simple, it's more of a "Google collaborates with carriers" rather than just "sends the update to carriers") -> Carriers approve the update -> Google releases the update and sends it to your phone.

**blaqice** • 3mo ago

Pixel 8

I just recently added another SIM on a different network to my phone. Now I'm wondering, does it matter which carrier-approved update I download?

[Skip to main content](#)[Create](#)**matteventu** • 3mo ago

Pixel C, 1 XL, 3, 6, 8 Pro, 9 Pro | Pixel Buds Pro Top 1% Commenter

That's a good question, I have no idea!

I guess it either:

- Waits for the update to be certified by both carriers, and only then it downloads the OTA

Or

- Automatically determines (in some way) which carrier to consider the "main" one, and downloads the update once approved by that carrier.

Looks more like the second option based on your experience, but it may vary?

**macewank** • 3mo ago

Just Black

9 times out of 10 everyone gets the same update. In the rare case your carriers get different updates it almost certainly won't matter which one you get.

**USSHammond** • 3mo ago

Pixel 10 Pro XL

**Vast_Umpire_3713** OP • 3mo ago

That makes sense. What if someone has never had a sim card on the phone?

**armando_rod** • 3mo ago

Pixel 10 Pro XL Top 1% Poster

It pulls the no-carrier build

**Vast_Umpire_3713** OP • 3mo ago

How can a phone become unlinked to a carrier once a sim card was inserted in? Factory reset?

**armando_rod** • 3mo ago

Pixel 10 Pro XL Top 1% Poster

I think you just take out the SIM and restart, but you still need to wait for a new OTA to be released

**VeloxAdAstra** • 3mo ago

I kinda doubt Mint Mobile has a build for my Pixel 10 XL.



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T-Mobile and T-Mobile MVNOs. For example, in December of 2024, there were 3 OTAs for the Pixel 8. There was a standard one, one just for Telstra, and another for T-Mobile.

<https://developers.google.com/android/ota#shiba>



VeloxAdAstra • 3mo ago

Interesting. I hope this doesn't happen to me because I purchased unlocked as an attempt to avoid these exact situations.



jpep0469 • 3mo ago

I wouldn't worry about it. It's only happened a few times and the delay was minimal.



Vast_Umpire_3713 **OP** • 3mo ago

Does that mean that you receive the update directly without your carrier being involved?



Jack_Shid • 3mo ago

Pixel 10 Pro Fold and Pixel 10 Pro XL on T-Mobile **Top 1% Commenter**

No. The update must be approved by your carrier. For example, it took longer for T-Mobile to approve this latest update than other carriers, so the update was delayed for T-Mobile customers.



VeloxAdAstra • 3mo ago

That's been my observation. I bought my phone unlocked from Google and activated it on Mint. No subsidies.



Jack_Shid • 3mo ago

Pixel 10 Pro Fold and Pixel 10 Pro XL on T-Mobile **Top 1% Commenter**

They're sent by Google, but not until approved by your carrier.



Vast_Umpire_3713 **OP** • 3mo ago

I wonder what a carrier would agree on. Does this mean that carriers use different technologies for communication? I thought there were the same standards for everyone (4G LTE or 5G should be the same. Am I wrong?)



Jack_Shid • 3mo ago

Pixel 10 Pro Fold and Pixel 10 Pro XL on T-Mobile **Top 1% Commenter**

Does this mean that carriers use different technologies for communication?

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Maybe in the US only?

**Jack_Shid** • 3mo agoPixel 10 Pro Fold and Pixel 10 Pro XL on T-Mobile [Top 1% Commenter](#)

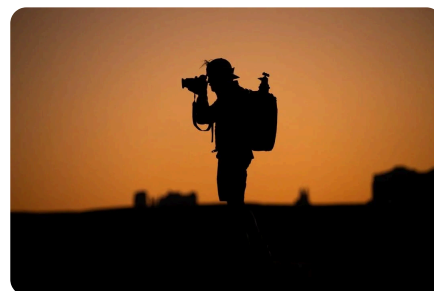
I doubt it. All carriers use different protocols. All updates must be compatible with each carrier's protocols

**etphonehome109** • 3mo ago

thank you. i didn't know it needed to be vetted by the main carriers. i thought that only applies to VZ.

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Gear tested on real shoots. Not marketing decks.

[Shop Now](#)guragear.com**HappiestSadGirl_** • 3mo ago

They're sent by Google but sometimes your carrier wants to "certify" it.

If you're impatient you could always update via ADB

**DrZaius119** • 3mo ago

Pixel 10 Pro XL

Thanks for all of you posting and verifying the correct response for the US. I still have some people argue with me that they bought the phone "unlocked" and all their updates come straight from Google without carrier intervention. Simply not true. If you have a SIM on your device for a US carrier, you won't get the update (without the ADB route) until the carrier approves/certifies it.

**matteventu** • 3mo agoPixel C, 1 XL, 3, 6, 8 Pro, 9 Pro | Pixel Buds Pro [Top 1% Commenter](#)

That is wrong.

All updates come from Google.

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It happens more in the US very simply because they're more involved and that's one of the places where Pixels are more popular.

**DrZaius119** • 3mo ago

Pixel 10 Pro XL

I never said they didn't come from Google. Reread what I said. I said they can't come without carrier intervention.

**matteventu** • 3mo ago

Pixel C, 1 XL, 3, 6, 8 Pro, 9 Pro | Pixel Buds Pro Top 1% Commenter

What those people mean with "no carrier intervention" is just that carriers don't add random crap to the updates.

**[deleted]** • 3mo ago**Vast_Umpire_3713** **OP** • 3mo ago

You are welcome

**armando_rod** • 3mo ago

Pixel 10 Pro XL Top 1% Poster

Your edit is wrong, it happens with a few other countries too like Australia Telstra

**Vast_Umpire_3713** **OP** • 3mo ago

Thanks. I'll update it then